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Intro- duction

Too many books on frugal living focus on the negative, throwing around words like sacrifice and responsibility as if there'd been a fire sale at the Boring Store.

We believe the key to financial wellness isn't a ramen-eating, vacation-skipping, fun-deprived life. In fact, we love to indulge in life's pleasures whenever we can—just as long as they fit into our budget. The best way to stick to a budget, especially in tough economic times, is to create a lifestyle that is as much fun as it is practical. Are you ready to live large within your means, no matter how small they may be?

This book will show you how. We are the writers of WiseBread.com—one of the most popular (and certainly the friendliest) personal finance communities online. We come from a rich array of backgrounds. Among our ranks there have been financial consultants, homemakers, journalists, career counselors, professors, and even professional hobos! Together, we will bring you the best tips based on our